

Health of the Humanities in Appalachia

An Assessment of NEH Funding to Rural Appalachia (2018-2023)

Codebook and Methodology

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Prepared by:

Maya A. Dalton, *Intern*

With support from:

Benjamin Skinner, *Humanities Data Scientist*

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Overview

This codebook explains the variables used to analyze the health of the humanities in the Appalachian region. The data is from five sources:

1. Publicly accessible grant data ([NEH data.gov, 2024](https://www.neh.gov/data))
2. The Appalachian Regional Commission (ARC) ([ARC, 2023](https://www.arc.gov))
3. The Small Area Income and Poverty Estimates (SAIPE) ([US Census Bureau, 2023](https://www.census.gov/saipe))
4. The Local Area Unemployment Statistics (LAUS) ([US Bureau of Labor Statistics, 2024](https://www.bls.gov/louis))
5. The Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS) ([National Center for Education Statistics \(NCES\), 2023](https://nces.ed/ipeds))

All of the data used in the analysis is based on grants and socioeconomic variables from 2018-2023. Before conducting my analysis, the data was cleaned to include these years and only states and counties designated to be in the Appalachian region. Please find the replication materials [here](#).

Variables

Variable Name	Description	Source
appnumber	Unique identifier: The official tracking number assigned to each application and listed in all NEH reports	NEH Grant Data (from NEH)
unitid	Unique identification number assigned to postsecondary institutions	IPEDS Data
institution	Name of institution with which grantee/project director is affiliated, provided by applicant/grantee. If the grantee/project director is not affiliated with an institution, the institution is listed as an "Unaffiliated Independent Scholar."	NEH Grant Data (provided by applicant/grantee)
org_type	Organization type, provided by applicant/grantee, as follows: Art Museum, Arts-Related Organization, Center for Advanced Study/Research Institute, Four-Year College, History Museum, Historic Preservation Organization, Historical Site/House, Historical Society, Museum, National Organization, Nature Center/Botanical Garden/Arboretum, Natural History Museum, Non-Profit Educational Center, Philanthropic Foundation, Public Library, Publishing, School	NEH Grant Data (provided by applicant/grantee)

	District, Secondary School, State/Local/Federal Government, Television Station, Two-Year College, Unknown, University	
cbb	The Carnegie Basic Classification is an update of the traditional classification framework developed by the Carnegie Commission on Higher Education in 1970 to support its research program and later published in 1973 for use by other researchers. 1: Associate's - Public 2: Associate's - Private 3: Research University (Very High Activity) 4: Research University (High Activity) 5: Doctoral/Research University 6: Master's (Large) 7: Master's (Medium) 8: Master's (Small) 9: Baccalaureate Colleges 10: Faith-Related Institutions 11: Medical Schools 12: Other health profession schools 13: Engineering Schools 14: Other tech-related schools 15: Business/Management Schools 16: Art, Music, and Design Schools 17: Law Schools 18: Other Special-Focus Institutions 19: Tribal Colleges -2: NA	IPEDS Data, recoded for easier analysis
hbcu	A code to indicate whether the institution is one of the Historically Black College or University (HBCU) institutions. 1: Yes 0: No	IPEDS Data
instcity	City of institution, provided by applicant/grantee.	NEH Grant Data (provided by applicant/grantee)
inststate	State abbreviation, as follows: AL GA	All datasets, subsetted from ARC designation

	KY MD MS NY NC OH PA SC TN VA WV	
stname	Full state name, as follows: Alabama Georgia Kentucky Maryland Mississippi New York North Carolina Ohio Pennsylvania South Carolina Tennessee Virginia West Virginia	All datasets, subsetted from ARC designation
county	County name	Based on ARC designation (see Appendix A for full list of counties)
appalachia	Binary indicator if county is in Appalachian region: 1: Yes 0: No	Based on ARC designation (see Appendix A for full list of counties)
fips	5-digit Federal Information Processing Series (FIPS) Code assigned and maintained by the Census Bureau	SAIPE from US Census Bureau and LAUS from BLS
zip	Postal code of institution. Empty string if project director/grantee is unaffiliated	NEH Grant Data
lon	Longitude of grantee	NEH Grant Data
lat	Latitude of grantee	NEH Grant Data
yearawarded	Fiscal year of grant	NEH Grant Data (from NEH)
title	Title of project, provided by applicant/grantee.	NEH Grant Data (provided by applicant/grantee)
program	NEH program through which grant was made. Includes 52 unique NEH grant programs.	NEH Grant Data (from NEH)
division	NEH division through which grant was made: Agency-wide Projects, Challenge Programs,	NEH Grant Data (from NEH)

	Digital Humanities, Education Programs, Preservation and Access, Public Programs, Research Programs	
totaward	Amount actually awarded (outright funds). Awarded amounts -- both outright and matching -- may be less than the approved amounts	NEH Grant Data (from NEH)
parentdiscipline	The grant's discipline: Area Studies, Arts, History, Interdisciplinary, Language, Literature, Social Science, Unknown	Hand-coded based on title, primary, and secondary disciplines (see Appendix B for discussion)
primarydiscipline	The grant's primary humanities discipline – includes 76 unique disciplines, provided by applicant/grantee.	NEH Grant Data (provided by applicant/grantee)
disciplines	An optional element for additional disciplines as provided by applicant/grantee.	NEH Grant Data (provided by applicant/grantee)
unemp_rate	Seasonally adjusted unemployment estimates for counties from 2018-2023	LAUS from BLS
poverty_rate	Estimated percent of people of all ages in poverty by county from 2018-2022	SAIPE from US Census Bureau
fips_all_totaward	Aggregate total award for unique FIPS code (all time)	NEH Grant Data
fips_yr_totaward	Aggregate total award for unique FIPS code and year	NEH Grant Data

References

Appalachian Regional Commission. 2022. “Appalachian Counties Served by ARC.” *Appalachian Regional Commission*. <https://www.arc.gov/appalachian-counties-served-by-arc/>.

National Center for Education Statistics (NCES). 2023. “Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).” <https://nces.ed.gov/ipeds/datacenter/DataFiles.aspx?gotoReportId=7&fromIpedS=true&sid=aa7e6b22-7bde-4560-b773-08d66a1c3568&rtid=7>

“NEH Data.Gov.” 2024. <https://catalog.data.gov/organization/neh-gov>.

US Bureau of Labor Statistics. 2024. “Local Area Unemployment Statistics (LAUS).” <https://www.bls.gov/lau/tables.htm>.

US Census Bureau. 2023. “Small Area Income and Poverty Estimates (SAIPE).” <https://www.census.gov/data-tools/demo/saipe>.

Appendices

Appendix A – Appalachian Counties Included in Analysis

- **Alabama (37 counties):** Bibb, Blount, Calhoun, Chambers, Cherokee, Chilton, Clay, Cleburne, Colbert, Coosa, Cullman, De Kalb, Elmore, Etowah, Fayette, Franklin, Hale, Jackson, Jefferson, Lamar, Lauderdale, Lawrence, Limestone, Macon, Madison, Marion, Marshall, Morgan, Pickens, Randolph, St. Clair, Shelby, Talladega, Tallapoosa, Tuscaloosa, Walker, and Winston
- **Georgia (37 counties):** Banks, Barrow, Bartow, Carroll, Catoosa, Chattooga, Cherokee, Dade, Dawson, Douglas, Elbert, Fannin, Floyd, Forsyth, Franklin, Gilmer, Gordon, Gwinnett, Habersham, Hall, Haralson, Hart, Heard, Jackson, Lumpkin, Madison, Murray, Paulding, Pickens, Polk, Rabun, Stephens, Towns, Union, Walker, White, and Whitfield
- **Kentucky (54 counties):** Adair, Bath, Bell, Boyd, Breathitt, Carter, Casey, Clark, Clay, Clinton, Cumberland, Edmonson, Elliott, Estill, Fleming, Floyd, Garrard, Green, Greenup, Harlan, Hart, Jackson, Johnson, Knott, Knox, Laurel, Lawrence, Lee, Leslie, Letcher, Lewis, Lincoln, McCreary, Madison, Magoffin, Martin, Menifee, Metcalfe, Monroe, Montgomery, Morgan, Nicholas, Owsley, Perry, Pike, Powell, Pulaski, Robertson, Rockcastle, Rowan, Russell, Wayne, Whitley, and Wolfe
- **Maryland (3 counties):** Allegany, Garrett, and Washington
- **Mississippi (24 counties):** Alcorn, Benton, Calhoun, Chickasaw, Choctaw, Clay, Itawamba, Kemper, Lee, Lowndes, Marshall, Monroe, Montgomery, Noxubee, Oktibbeha, Panola, Pontotoc, Prentiss, Tippah, Tishomingo, Union, Webster, Winston, and Yalobusha
- **New York (14 counties):** Allegany, Broome, Cattaraugus, Chautauqua, Chemung, Chenango, Cortland, Delaware, Otsego, Schoharie, Schuyler, Steuben, Tioga, and Tompkins
- **North Carolina (31 counties):** Alexander, Alleghany, Ashe, Avery, Buncombe, Burke, Caldwell, Catawba, Cherokee, Clay, Cleveland, Davie, Forsyth, Graham, Haywood, Henderson, Jackson, McDowell, Macon, Madison, Mitchell, Polk, Rutherford, Stokes, Surry, Swain, Transylvania, Watauga, Wilkes, Yadkin, and Yancey
- **Ohio (32 counties):** Adams, Ashtabula, Athens, Belmont, Brown, Carroll, Clermont, Columbiana, Coshocton, Gallia, Guernsey, Harrison, Highland, Hocking, Holmes, Jackson, Jefferson, Lawrence, Mahoning, Meigs, Monroe, Morgan, Muskingum, Noble, Perry, Pike, Ross, Scioto, Trumbull, Tuscarawas, Vinton, and Washington
- **Pennsylvania (52 counties):** Allegheny, Armstrong, Beaver, Bedford, Blair, Bradford, Butler, Cambria, Cameron, Carbon, Centre, Clarion, Clearfield, Clinton, Columbia, Crawford, Elk, Erie, Fayette, Forest, Fulton, Greene, Huntingdon, Indiana, Jefferson, Juniata, Lackawanna, Lawrence, Luzerne, Lycoming, McKean, Mercer, Mifflin, Monroe, Montour, Northumberland, Perry, Pike, Potter, Schuylkill, Snyder, Somerset, Sullivan, Susquehanna, Tioga, Union, Venango, Warren, Washington, Wayne, Westmoreland, and Wyoming
- **South Carolina (7 counties):** Anderson, Cherokee, Greenville, Oconee, Pickens, Spartanburg, and Union
- **Tennessee (52 counties):** Anderson, Bledsoe, Blount, Bradley, Campbell, Cannon, Carter, Claiborne, Clay, Cocke, Coffee, Cumberland, De Kalb, Fentress, Franklin, Grainger, Greene, Grundy, Hamblen, Hamilton, Hancock, Hawkins, Jackson, Jefferson, Johnson, Knox, Lawrence, Lewis, Loudon, McMinn, Macon, Marion, Meigs, Monroe, Morgan, Overton, Pickett, Polk, Putnam, Rhea, Roane, Scott, Sequatchie, Sevier, Smith, Sullivan, Unicoi, Union, Van Buren, Warren, Washington, and White

- **Virginia (25 counties):** Alleghany, Bath, Bland, Botetourt, Buchanan, Carroll, Craig, Dickenson, Floyd, Giles, Grayson, Henry, Highland, Lee, Montgomery, Patrick, Pulaski, Rockbridge, Russell, Scott, Smyth, Tazewell, Washington, Wise, and Wythe
 - The following independent cities in Virginia are also within the Appalachian Region and are merged with an adjacent or surrounding county for the purposes of data analysis and grant management: Bristol (Washington County), Buena Vista (Rockbridge County), Covington (Alleghany County), Galax (Carroll County), Lexington (Rockbridge County), Martinsville (Henry County), Norton (Wise County), and Radford (Montgomery County)
- **West Virginia (55 counties):** Barbour, Berkeley, Boone, Braxton, Brooke, Cabell, Calhoun, Clay, Doddridge, Fayette, Gilmer, Grant, Greenbrier, Hampshire, Hancock, Hardy, Harrison, Jackson, Jefferson, Kanawha, Lewis, Lincoln, Logan, Marion, Marshall, Mason, McDowell, Mercer, Mineral, Mingo, Monongalia, Monroe, Morgan, Nicholas, Ohio, Pendleton, Pleasants, Pocahontas, Preston, Putnam, Raleigh, Randolph, Ritchie, Roane, Summers, Taylor, Tucker, Tyler, Upshur, Wayne, Webster, Wetzel, Wirt, Wood, and Wyoming

Appendix B – Re-categorization of Project Disciplines

NEH publicly available data includes two columns: primary and secondary discipline. These columns are more fine-grained details on each project's field of study. For example, primary discipline may include U.S. History or Art History, whereas secondary discipline may include Middle Eastern Studies or Jewish History. To provide more overarching summary statistics, I manually coded an umbrella discipline for each project in the following categories: Area Studies, Arts, Language, Literature, History, Interdisciplinary, Social Science, and NA. I chose these categories based on reviewing the primary and secondary disciplines, as well as the eGMS reports from each award. It is important to note that changing lower-order categorization to higher-order categorization can result in a loss of information. However, this change allows for an analysis of general disciplines that receive certain amounts of funding. Additionally, the Unknown or NA discipline categories are typically attributed to state humanities councils, where the funding is allocated by the council itself and does not have a specific discipline. The specific categorization can be found below:

- **Arts** include any primary discipline with the keywords: Art, Arts, Dance, Film, Media, Music, Theater, Ethnomusicology, or Aesthetics
- **History** includes any primary discipline with the keywords: History, Civilization, Renaissance Studies, or Medieval Studies
- **Literature** includes any primary discipline with the keywords: Literature, Literary, Classics, English [Literature], or Composition and Rhetoric
- **Language** includes any primary discipline with the keywords: Language(s) or Linguistic(s)
- **Humanities** includes any primary discipline with the keywords: Anthropology, Archaeology, Religion, Logic, Digital Preservation, Journalism, Folklore and Folklife, Ethics, Philosophy, Law, or Phenomenology
- **Social Sciences** includes any primary discipline with the keywords: Social Sciences, Architecture, Communications, Gender, Geography, Politics, Political, International [Relations], Government, Conservation, Psychology, Sociology, or Economics
- **Interdisciplinary** includes any primary discipline with the keyword: Interdisciplinary
- **Area Studies** includes any primary disciplines remaining following the above categorizations with the keyword: Studies